Mike Bwalya

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Environmental and aquaculture researcher with a Bachelor of Science in Fisheries and Aquaculture and currently pursuing a Master of Science in Biology (Ecology and Biodiversity) at the Copperbelt University. I am currently in the final stage of data collection for my MSc research, focusing on environmental and aquatic ecosystem analysis.

Possesses over three years of professional experience in environmental monitoring, aquaculture development, biodiversity auditing, and field data collection. Experienced in ecological research, water quality monitoring, fisheries assessment, and statistical data analysis using tools such as SPSS, Excel, R, and Stata.

Demonstrated ability to work with communities, government institutions, research teams, and development organizations to support sustainable resource management and environmental conservation initiatives. Passionate about contributing to sustainable aquaculture, biodiversity conservation, climate resilience, and food security.

KEY SKILLS AND COMPETENCIES

Environmental & Research Skills

- Biodiversity Auditing and Environmental Monitoring
- Aquaculture Research and Water Quality Assessment
- Fisheries Resource Assessment
- Ecological Field Data Collection
- Environmental Impact Monitoring

Data & Analytical Skills

- Statistical Analysis (SPSS, Excel, R, Stata)
- Survey Design and Field Research
- Data Visualization and Reporting
- Mobile Data Collection (KoboCollect)

Technical & IT Skills

- Web Development (HTML, CSS, PHP, SQL, Bootstrap)
- Python Programming (Django, Flask)
- Computer Networking and Cybersecurity

Professional Skills

- Scientific Research and Technical Writing
- Community Engagement and Capacity Building
- Teaching and Science Education
- Project Support and Monitoring

EDUCATION

Master of Science (MSc) – Biology (Ecology and Biodiversity)
Copperbelt University, Zambia
Expected Graduation: **October 2026**

Diploma in Teaching Methodology
Technical and Vocational Teachers' College (TVTC), Zambia
Expected Completion: **December 2026**

Bachelor of Science (BSc) – Fisheries and Aquaculture
Copperbelt University, Zambia
Graduated: **November 2019**

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

- ISO 14001: Environmental Management Systems *(In Progress)*
- Certificate in Data Analysis – Copperbelt University
- Certificate in Business Analytics in Excel – Alison
- Certificate in Data Science with R Programming – SkillUp
- Computer Networking: Local Area Networks and OSI Model
- Introduction to Programming with Python
- Introduction to Cyber Security

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Enumerator – Industrial Energy Use Mapping Study:

Research Methods International - Energy Efficiency for Sustainable Livelihoods in Africa (Zambia) | February – March 2026

- **Administered structured questionnaires to industrial enterprises.**
- **Collected data on energy use, production practices, and operational characteristics.**
- **Ensured compliance with ethical standards and data quality requirements.**
- **Used digital tools (tablets/smartphones) for data entry and survey submission.**
- **Conducted field visits to enterprises across the assigned province.**

Enumerator – Baseline Assessment

Primson Management Services – Equal Chances for Human Development Programme
Luapula Province | January 2026

- Conducted baseline data collection for the EC4HD Programme.
- Collected household socio-economic data through structured surveys.
- Engaged with community members to ensure reliable program data.
- Supported data verification and reporting processes.

Enumerator – Fish Market Characterization Project

KilimoTrust & Lattice Africa
Chililabombwe | May 2025

- Collected fisheries trade and biodiversity data using KoboCollect.
- Conducted interviews with fish traders and market stakeholders.
- Ensured adherence to ethical data collection standards.

Research Assistant – Biodiversity Auditing

Kansanshi Mining (First Quantum Minerals)
Solwezi | September 2024

- Assisted with biodiversity assessments and ecological monitoring.
- Collected environmental data for compliance and conservation reports.
- Supported environmental impact documentation.

Community Volunteer

Citizen Economic Empowerment Commission (CEEC)
August 2023 – December 2023

- Assisted community members in applying for empowerment grants and loans.
- Supported cooperative registration and proposal development.
- Facilitated entrepreneurship awareness programs.

Aquaculture Research Officer

Ministry of Fisheries and Livestock – Solwezi District
2020 – 2022

- Conducted aquaculture research and monitored fish farming activities.
- Performed water quality assessments and fish health monitoring.
- Assisted in fingerling distribution and aquaculture extension services.
- Provided technical support to fish farmers.

Teaching Practice Intern (Biology and Chemistry)

Kitwe Boys Secondary School
2023

- Taught Biology and Chemistry to senior secondary students.
- Assisted in laboratory practical sessions in Biology, Chemistry, and Physics.

Freelance Science Tutor

Kitwe | 2013 – Present

- Provide tutoring in Biology, Chemistry, Mathematics, and Physics for Grades 8–12.
- Prepare students for ECZ and Cambridge examinations.
- Conduct science practical training sessions.

Freelance Web Developer and Computer Systems Specialist

Remote | 2020 – Present

- Develop websites using HTML, CSS, Bootstrap, PHP, SQL, and Python frameworks.
- Provide IT consulting services including cybersecurity awareness.

Projects Links

- ✓ https://bwalya12.github.io/Zambia_Virtual_Farm_Market/
- ✓ https://bwalya12.github.io/masoka_manda/
- ✓ https://bwalya12.github.io/cdf_online_system_version2/

Research Consultant (Freelance)

Remote | 2021 – Present

- Assist university students with research design and data analysis.
- Support research projects in Business Administration, Nursing, and Aquaculture.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Undergraduate Research Project
Effects of Copper Deposits on Tilapia in Aquatic Systems: A Case Study of the Kafue River in Kitwe District.

Master's Research Proposal (Approved)
Assessment of Heavy Metals Bioaccumulation and Microbial Diversity in Farmed and Wild Tilapia in the Kafue River of Kitwe District.

Proposal Presentation: **19 May 2025**

PUBLICATIONS AND ACADEMIC WRITING

Review Article (Ongoing)
The Rising Cost of Protein-Based Fish Feed: Exploring Sustainable Alternatives for Aquaculture.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Data and Statistical Tools

- SPSS
- Microsoft Excel

- R Programming
- Stata

Programming and Web Development

- HTML
- CSS
- JavaScript
- PHP
- SQL
- Python
- Django
- Flask
- Bootstrap

Other Skills

- Environmental Monitoring
- Biodiversity Auditing
- Data Entry and Visualization
- Computer Networking

LANGUAGES

- English – Fluent
- Bemba – Fluent

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Founder – Buchi Aquaculture Cooperative, Kitwe

Focused on promoting **sustainable aquaculture, climate resilience, and fingerling supply** to local farmers.

REFERENCES

Prof. Subbaiya Ramasamy
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Copperbelt University
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